3. ***Declaration of ASEAN Concord, Bali, 24 February 1976:*** This Declaration upheld the pledge of the ASEAN countries to work towards the expansion of political co-operation. To this end the Declaration adopted principles for regional stability and a programme of action for political cooperation such as the signing of Treaty of Amity and Cooperation in South East Asia (TAC) and setting of intraregional disputes "by peaceful means as soon as possible".

4. ***Treaty of Amity and Cooperation in South East Asia: Bali, 24 February 1976:*** The Treaty enshrines the following principles: mutual respect for one another's sovereignty; non-interference in the internal affairs; peaceful settlement of intra-regional disputes; and effective cooperation. The Treaty also provides for a code of conduct for the peaceful settlement of disputes, and it mandates the establishment of a high council made up of ministerial representatives from the parties as a dispute–settlement mechanism.

5. ***ASEAN Declaration on the South China Sea, Manila, 22 July 1992:*** This Declaration was adopted to create an atmosphere of peace and stability in the South China Sea. This Declaration urged "all parties concerned to exercise restraint in order to create a positive climate for the eventual resolution of all disputes".

6. ***ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF) in 1994:*** In recognition of security interdependence in the Asia-Pacific region, the ASEAN established the ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF) in 1994. The ARF's agenda aims at evolving in three broad stages, namely, the promotion of confidence-building, development of preventive diplomacy and elaboration of approaches to conflicts. The present participants in the ARF include 10 member countries, the dialogue partners and Democratic People's Republic of Korea (North Korea), Republic of Korea (South Korea), and Mongolia. The ARF discusses the major regional security issues in the region, including the relationship among the major powers, non-proliferation, counter-terrorism, transnational crime, South China Sea and the Korean Peninsula, among others.

7. ***Treaty on the South East Asia Nuclear Weapon-Free Zone: (SEANWFZ), Bangkok, 15 December 1997:*** The leaders of all the